HARIHARAN GANGADHARAN

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Builder and operator with 4 years of experience across ventures, B2B SaaS, and government innovation. Specialised in translating strategy into execution, managing high-value pipelines, and driving cross-functional coordination in complex multi-stakeholder environments. From founding a student startup at 19 to co-developing India's first Public Sector Innovation Policy with OECD and UNICEF, I have consistently been the person who builds the system, manages the room, and gets things done.

₹100 Cr	50+	₹20 Cr+	10+
Fund Managed	Proposals Evaluated	Pipeline Managed	Global stakeholders

CORE SKILLS

Operations

- Pipeline and fund management
- M&E framework design
- Process reengineering
- RFP preparation
- Proposal lifecycle management

Stakeholder & Governance

- Inter-departmental coordination
- Global partner engagement
- Policy execution at scale
- Institutional framework design
- Leadership communication

Execution & Communication Tools

- Notion (Workflow and pipeline management)
- Canva (leadership presentation design)
- PRD writing and wireframing
- No-code platform prototyping
- Metadata-driven knowledge base creation

WORK EXPERIENCE

State Planning Commission, Government of Tamil Nadu — **Sep 2024 to Present**

Innovation Consultant (Young Innovator) — *Mar 2025 to Present*

- Co-developing India's first Public Sector Innovation Policy in collaboration with OECD and UNICEF, contributing to policy design, implementation approaches, and institutional mechanisms for embedding innovation within government systems
- Part of the core team managing the Rs.100 Cr Tamil Nadu Innovation Initiatives (TANII) fund. Co-developed 50+ proposals worth Rs.20 Cr+ with sectoral departments by structuring ideas from the ground up, stress-testing them against operational and policy realities, pruning infeasible ones, and managing the pipeline to ensure only scalable, high-impact solutions advanced for funding consideration
- Built the TANII Tracker to solve the problem of fragmented proposal tracking across 35+ departments. Designed and managed on Notion, it gave the core innovation team a single system to track end-to-end proposal lifecycle, log progress, flag bottlenecks, and provide leadership with real-time visibility into the Rs.100 Cr fund pipeline
- Co-developed the Monitoring and Evaluation framework for TANII in collaboration with UNICEF Office of Innovation, designing KPIs, outcome metrics, portfolio tracking systems, and leadership dashboards for data-driven governance
- Developed and secured State Assembly approval for TNPAGE (Rs.10 Cr), a digital governance innovation centre focused on data-driven policymaking, knowledge systems, and experimentation within government
- Acted as the operational bridge between the State Planning Commission, OECD, UNICEF, and 10+ government departments, facilitating a first-of-its-kind subnational collaboration that included innovation index design, capacity building for innovation officers, and institutional framework development

- Organised and led global partner engagement for Tamil Nadu's first global education summit, coordinating with international stakeholders, industry bodies, and the Ministry while managing end-to-end logistics, agenda, and high-stakes relationship management at a state level
- Designed and executed the Startup-to-Government (S2G) Conclave, enabling structured collaboration between startups and government and supporting the translation of solutions into pilots
- Re-engineered public service delivery processes to improve last-mile access, service efficiency, and citizen experience with measurable departmental impact
- Developed policy recommendations on AI and the future of work, and contributed to policy exploration on blockchain in the public sector

Research Assistant
Jan 2025 to Mar 2025

- Prepared RFPs for evaluation studies aligned with governance objectives
- Proposed a Public Innovation Student Club model to engage youth in regional problem-solving, G2C service audits, and government app redesigns
- Conducted a feasibility study for a Digital Health Card System for Tamil Nadu, addressing infrastructure and policy gaps

Innovative Intern
Sep 2024 to Jan 2025

- Drafted TANII proposals in coordination with sectoral departments including Education, Health, and Agriculture, ensuring compliance with funding guidelines
- Created and managed a Notion-based product management environment to track the TANII Tracker lifecycle and log bug fixes
- Coordinated GovTech series and capacity-building programs, fostering governance innovation among government stakeholders

Noshack Solutions Private Limited

Co-Founder and Director
Aug 2022 to Mar 2024

- Co-built a decision intelligence layer for institutions, turning fragmented academic and accreditation data into strategic insights for higher education decision-making in the NEP 2020 era
- Led product research for NNBedu, a B2B SaaS platform, validated with institutional stakeholders and integrated with ONEST, a Government of India skilling initiative, demonstrating experience in compliance-sensitive and technology-led operations

Sync ED | Student Startup

Founder
Aug 2020 to Apr 2022

- Founded during college to build a collaborative student network enabling commerce students to enter the CRM industry by building portfolios through real-world client projects
- Managed 80+ student interns across live client projects, building early leadership and operational execution skills
- Conducted a 7-day workshop at DG Vaishnav College teaching Bank Management students product-building skills including Salesforce-based alumni portals and Excel macro-based POS systems

EDUCATION

Post Graduate Program in Product Management
Nov 2022 to Jul 2023

Duke Corporate Education

- Designed Tweedle, a decentralized e-commerce platform, applying the AARRR framework for GTM strategy
- Developed PRD for ONDC integration ensuring compliance with decentralized commerce standards

Bachelor of Technology, Information Technology
Sep 2018 to May 2022

Rajalakshmi Engineering College, Tamil Nadu

- Published research on Geo-fencing for COVID-19 Zone Tracking in Emerald Publications
- Built a Salesforce-based Leasehold Management System to streamline property processes